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PARK et al.(10) **Pub. No.: US 2025/0281476 A1**(43) **Pub. Date: Sep. 11, 2025**(54) **EFINACONAZOLE ORAL COMPOSITION**(71) Applicant: **DAEBONG LS CO., LTD.**, Incheon
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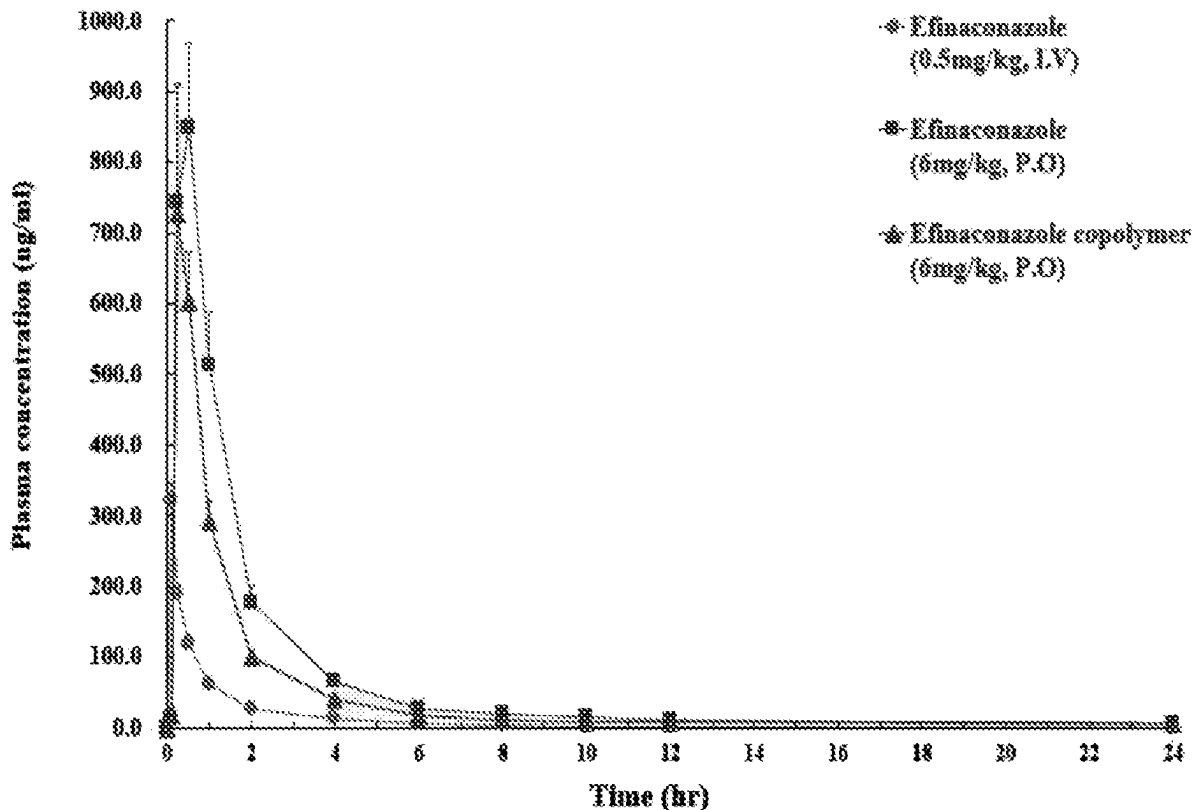
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(57)

ABSTRACT

The present invention relates to a composition for oral use including a co-formed product of efinaconazole and polyethylene glycol and a pharmaceutically acceptable additive. The composition of the present invention has high stability and bioavailability and is thus very effective when administered.



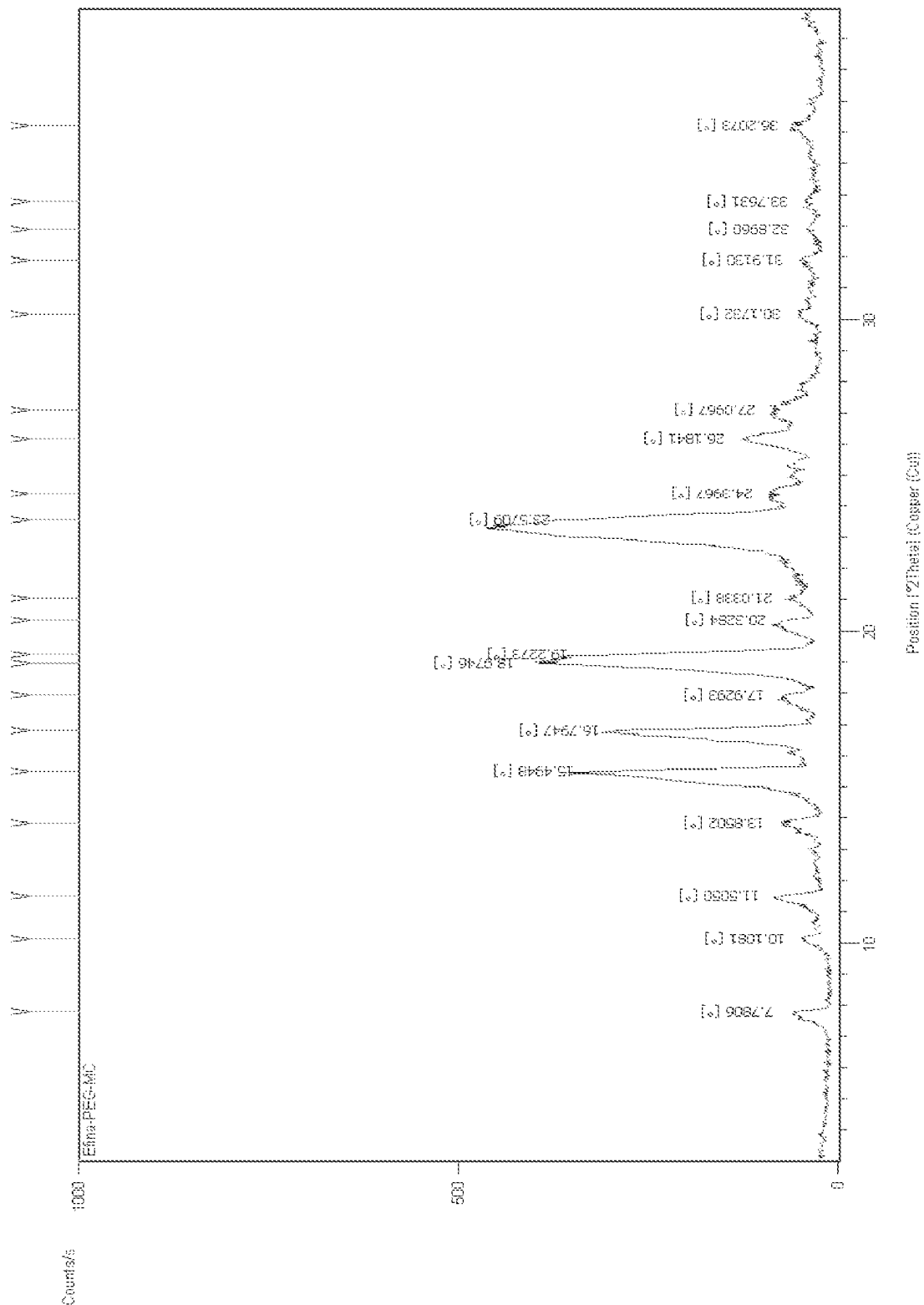


FIG. 1

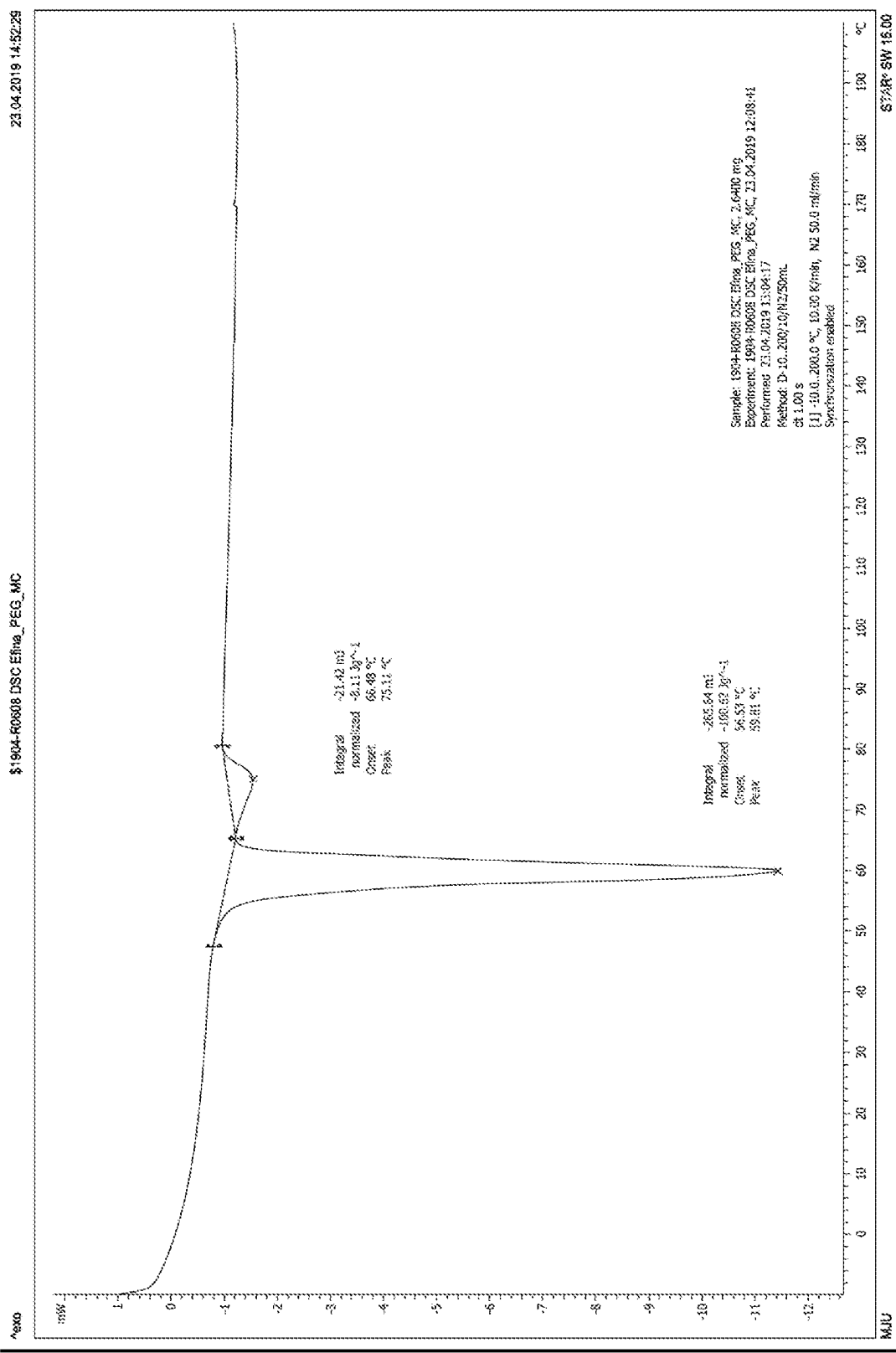


FIG. 2

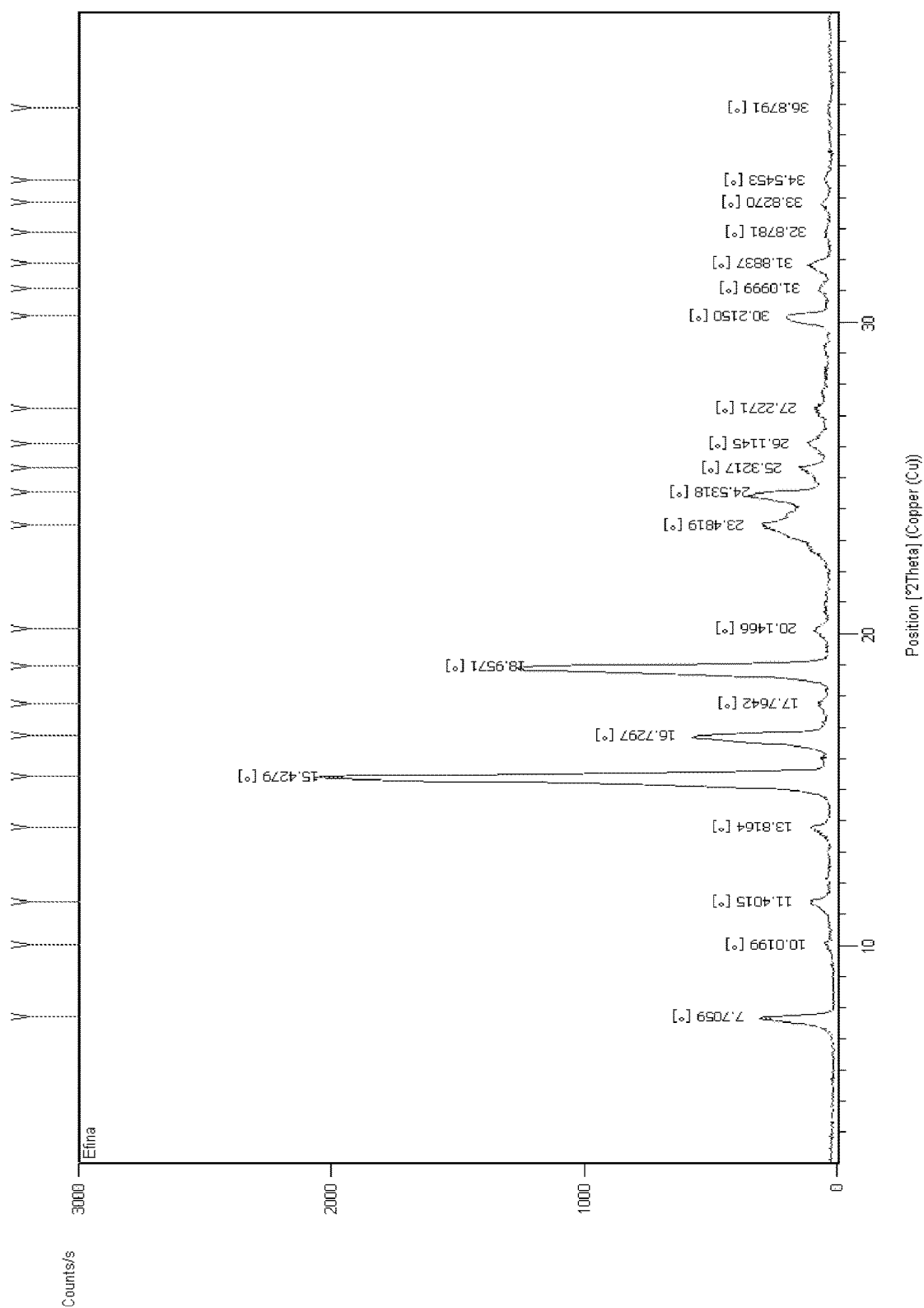


FIG. 3

FIG. 3

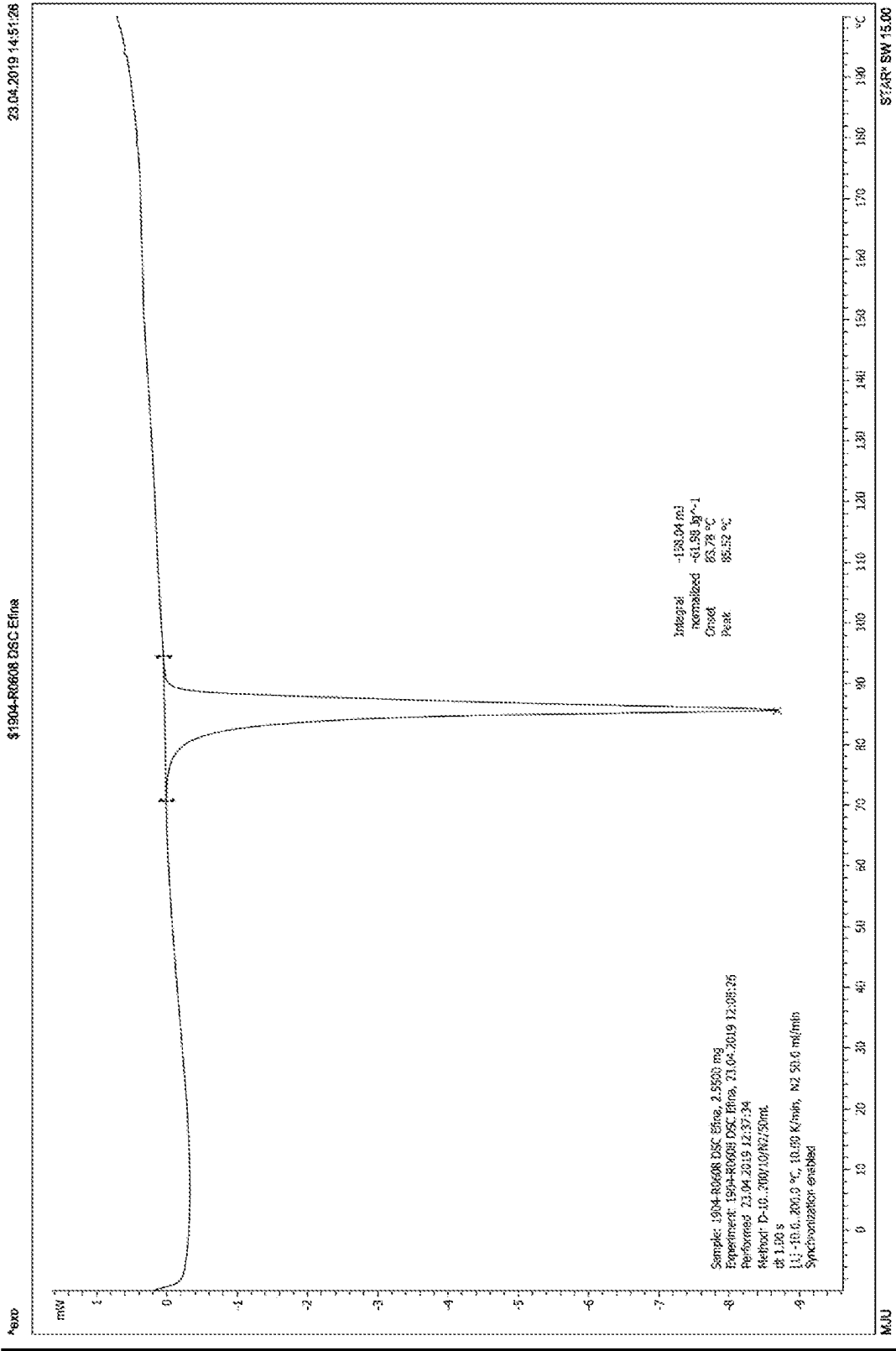


FIG. 4

Efinaconazole STABILITY TEST DATA-EXAMPLE 1

Solution (10%)	Temp (°C)	1 week		2 weeks		4 weeks	
		Purity(%)	Related substances(%)	Purity(%)	Related substances(%)	Purity(%)	Related substances(%)
Efinaconazole	Room Temp.	99.73	0.27	99.61	0.39	99.6	0.40
Example 1		99.79	0.21	99.80	0.20	99.79	0.21
Efinaconazole	65°C	99.55	0.45	99.46	0.54	98.47	1.53
Example 1		98.82	0.16	99.61	0.19	99.30	0.70

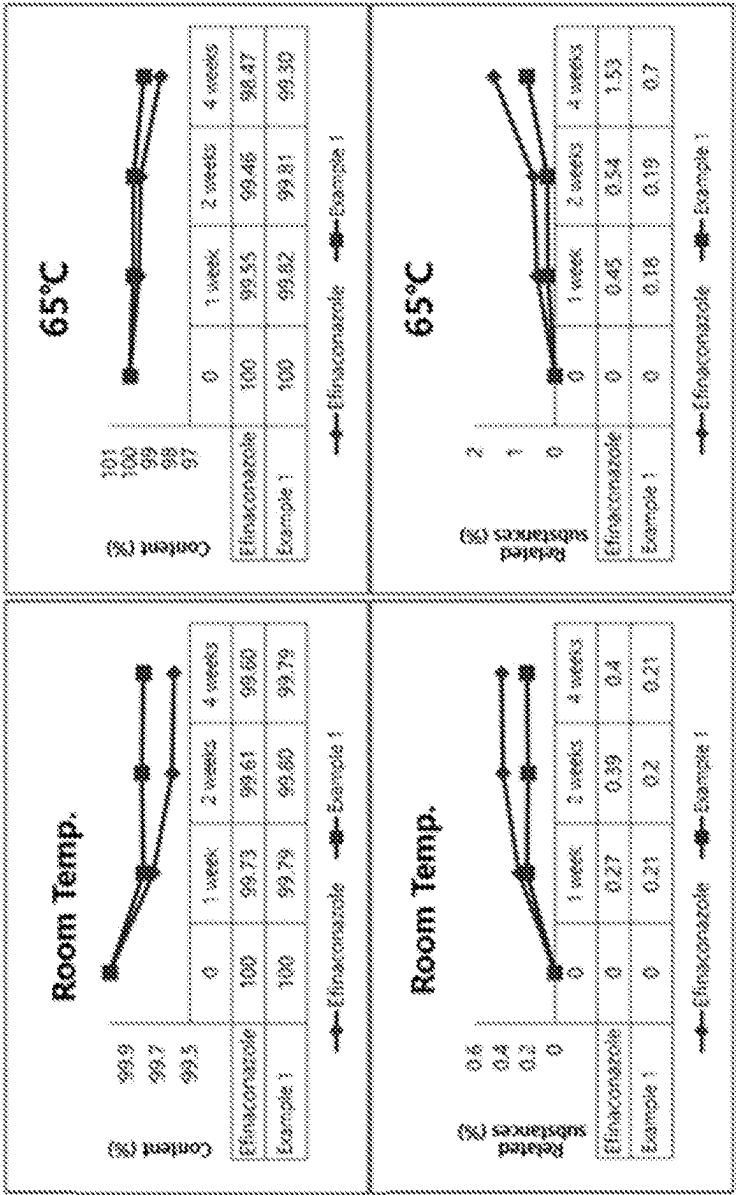


FIG. 5

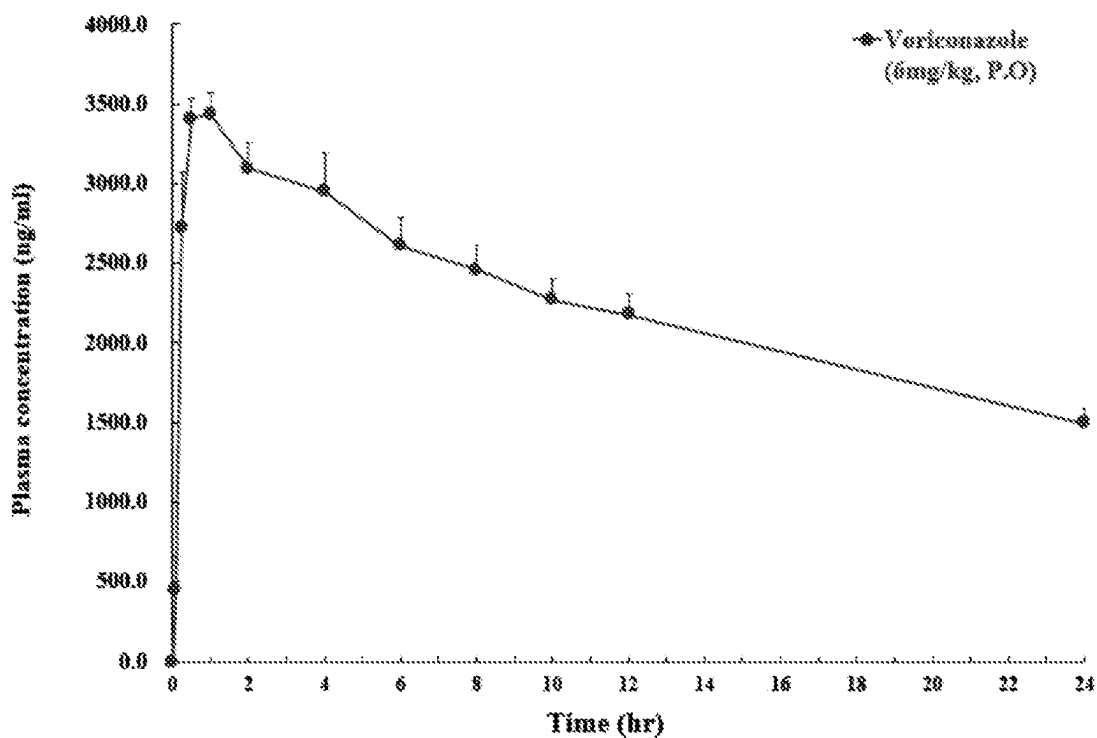


FIG. 6

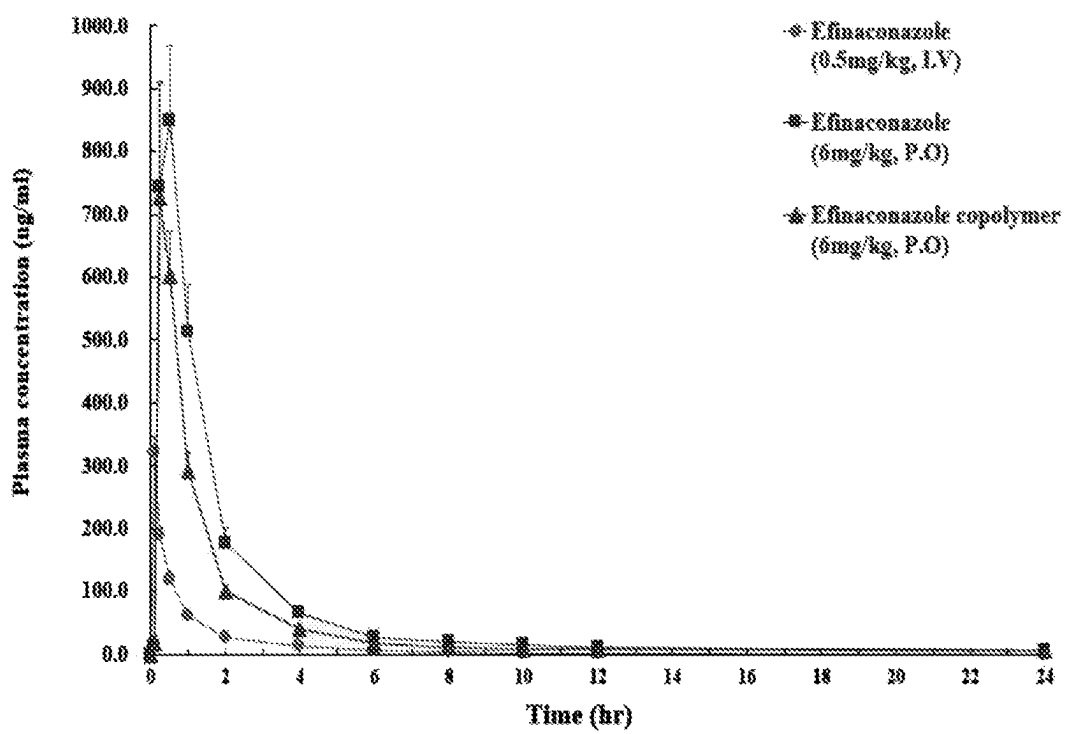


FIG. 7

EFINACONAZOLE ORAL COMPOSITION

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0001] The present invention relates to a composition for oral use including efinaconazole that has high stability and bioavailability and is thus very effective when administered.

BACKGROUND ART

[0002] Efinaconazole is a triazole compound with proven therapeutic activity for onychomycosis. Efinaconazole exhibits antifungal activity by inhibiting the synthesis of ergosterol, an essential constituent of the fungal cell membrane.

[0003] Jublia™ is a currently commercially available product for efinaconazole. Jublia employs efinaconazole as a major ingredient and is used to treat onychomycosis caused by dermatophytes. Jublia received approval for use in South Korea by the Korean Ministry of Food and Drug Safety and was launched in South Korea in May 2017.

[0004] Jublia is a formulation for topical application. Topical antifungals are relatively free from the disadvantages of oral antifungals, such as skin rash, hepatotoxicity, and digestive system side effects, and exhibit high medication compliance and preference.

[0005] Formulations useful for topical delivery of efinaconazole and other triazole antifungal drugs for the treatment of onychomycosis are described, for example, in U.S. Pat. No. 8,486,978 ("Patent Document 1").

[0006] However, formulations for topical application may be rather insufficient in inhibiting deep-rooted fungi due to the ability of fungi to penetrate the outer skin or nail and are somewhat limited in inhibiting and preventing fungi that spread widely throughout the entire body because they should be applied to lesions without leaving unapplied lesions.

[0007] Indeed, the reason why fungal diseases such as *Tinea manus*, *Tinea pedis*, and onychomycosis tend to recur is also closely related to the above-described limitations of formulations for topical application. That is, although formulations for topical application work well against fungi residing on the surface, they fail to work at desired effective concentrations to reach depths at which fungi are completely killed.

[0008] Thus, it is important to develop dosage forms (e.g., injections and tablets, solutions, capsules, and powders for oral use) that can deliver antifungal ingredients to target tissues through blood. It is particularly requested to develop oral formulations that are easy to take and have high medication compliance and preference.

[0009] However, efinaconazole has problems associated with uptake and bioavailability when administered orally due to its relatively low water solubility (~0.61 mg/mL).

[0010] Efinaconazole-containing solutions have the problem of poor stability, that is, they tend to discolor within short storage periods, resulting in composition colors ranging from yellow to deep red or brown. In an attempt to solve this stability problem, U.S. Pat. No. 9,662,394 discloses a liquid or semi-solid composition including a specific chelating agent, an antioxidant, and acids, specifically ethylenediaminetetraacetic acid (EDTA) or a salt thereof, butylated hydroxytoluene (BHT), and citric acid.

[0011] Therefore, a highly bioavailable and stable oral formulation including efinaconazole needs to be developed.

[0012] For reference, the following prior art documents are cited herein and are hereby incorporated by reference in their entirety.

[0013] (Patent Document 1) U.S. Pat. No. 8,486,978 B2 (Jul. 16, 2013)

[0014] (Patent Document 2) U.S. Pat. No. 9,662,394 B2 (May 30, 2017)

[0015] (Patent Document 3) U.S. Pat. No. 5,620,994 A (Apr. 15, 1997)

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

Problems to be Solved by the Invention

[0016] The present invention is intended to solve the problems of the prior art and to provide a highly bioavailable and stable oral formulation including efinaconazole.

Means for Solving the Problems

[0017] The present invention has been made in an effort to solve the problems of the prior art.

[0018] The present invention provides a pharmaceutical composition for oral use including a co-formed product of efinaconazole and polyethylene glycol and a pharmaceutically acceptable additive.

[0019] The pharmaceutical composition of the present invention may be formulated into a tablet or solution.

[0020] The pharmaceutical composition of the present invention may include 0.6 to 2040 mg of the efinaconazole.

[0021] The weight ratio of the efinaconazole to the polyethylene glycol in the co-formed product may be 1:1.

[0022] The pharmaceutically acceptable additive may be selected from the group consisting of excipients, binders, disintegrants, surfactants, lubricants, colorants, and mixtures thereof.

[0023] The excipients may be lactose hydrate, microcrystalline cellulose, microcrystalline cellulose-lactose, methyl cellulose, ethyl cellulose, hydroxyethyl cellulose, hydroxypropyl cellulose, hydroxypropyl methyl cellulose, carboxymethyl cellulose salts, other substituted and unsubstituted celluloses, corn starch, pregelatinized starch, lactose, anhydrous lactose, sugar alcohols, sucrose, xylitol, acrylate polymers and copolymers, dextrates, dextrin, dextrose, maltodextrin, pectin, gelatin, inorganic diluents, and mixtures thereof.

[0024] The binders may be polyvinyl alcohol-polyethylene glycol graft copolymers, polyvinylpyrrolidone vinyl acetate, ethyl cellulose, hydroxypropyl cellulose, hydroxypropyl methyl cellulose, carboxymethyl cellulose, methyl cellulose, polyvinyl alcohol, polyvinylpyrrolidone, polyacrylic acid, gelatin, propylene glycol, sodium alginate, and mixtures thereof.

[0025] The disintegrants may be croscarmellose sodium, crospovidone, carboxymethyl cellulose salts, hydroxypropyl cellulose, microcrystalline cellulose, pregelatinized starch, sodium starch, glycolate, sodium starch glycolate, and mixtures thereof.

[0026] The lubricants may be magnesium stearate, sodium stearyl fumarate, glyceryl behenate, and mixtures thereof.

[0027] The pharmaceutical composition of the present invention may be used to prevent or treat a fungal infection.

[0028] The fungal infection may be onychomycosis.

Effects of the Invention

[0029] The pharmaceutical composition of the present invention is suitable for oral administration due to its high stability and bioavailability.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0030] FIG. 1 is a powder XRD pattern of a co-crystal of efinaconazole and polyethylene glycol.

[0031] FIG. 2 is a DSC thermogram of a co-crystal of efinaconazole and polyethylene glycol.

[0032] FIG. 3 is a powder XRD pattern of a crystalline form of efinaconazole.

[0033] FIG. 4 is a DSC thermogram of a crystalline form of efinaconazole.

[0034] FIG. 5 shows graphs comparing the stability of a crystalline form of efinaconazole with that of a co-crystal of efinaconazole and polyethylene glycol.

[0035] FIG. 6 shows a time-blood voriconazole concentration curve in a preclinical experiment.

[0036] FIG. 7 shows time-blood efinaconazole concentration curves in a preclinical experiment.

BEST MODE FOR CARRYING OUT THE INVENTION

[0037] The present invention will now be described in detail.

[0038] The present invention is directed to a pharmaceutical composition for oral use including a co-formed product of efinaconazole and polyethylene glycol and a pharmaceutically acceptable additive.

[0039] A co-formed product is composed of two or more components and exhibits unique physical properties different from those of the individual components, just like a single material. Co-formed products are divided into co-amorphous products and co-crystals.

[0040] The term “co-crystal” refers to a crystal structure of two or more different molecules in a specific stoichiometric ratio within one crystal lattice. Intermolecular bonds in co-crystals are distinguished from those in salts and mixtures.

[0041] A co-crystal is a crystalline solid that is rich in functional groups (for example, O, OH, and N) capable of hydrogen bonding or has a new crystal structure through hydrogen bonding with a coformer in a regular ratio.

[0042] The term “coformer” refers to an inactive molecule constituting a co-crystal of a drug. In the present invention, polyethylene glycol is preferably selected as the coformer.

[0043] A powder XRD pattern and a DSC thermogram of a co-crystal of efinaconazole and polyethylene glycol are shown in FIGS. 1 and 2, respectively. A XRD pattern and a DSC thermogram of a crystalline form of efinaconazole are shown in FIGS. 3 and 4, respectively.

[0044] Comparative analysis of FIGS. 1 to 4 shows that the co-formed product of efinaconazole exhibits a completely different tendency from that of the crystalline form of efinaconazole.

[0045] That is, the co-formed product of efinaconazole and polyethylene glycol has a crystal structure that exhibits characteristic peaks at diffraction angles (2θ I/10>10%) of 7.78°, 11.50°, 13.85°, 15.49°, 16.79°, 18.97°, 19.22°, 23.57°, 26.18°, and 27.09° in its powder XRD pattern. The differential scanning calorimetry (DSC) thermogram of the co-formed product of efinaconazole and polyethylene glycol

has maximum endothermic peaks at 61.62° C. and 78.78° C. The XRD pattern and DSC thermogram of the co-formed product of efinaconazole and polyethylene glycol are distinctly different from those of the crystalline form of efinaconazole.

[0046] Therefore, it can be concluded that the co-formed product of efinaconazole is a novel substance having physicochemical properties entirely different from those of existing crystalline forms of efinaconazole.

[0047] Since efinaconazole is a somewhat unstable drug, its stability needs to be improved for use as an active ingredient of pharmaceutical compositions. The formation of the co-formed product can increase the stability of efinaconazole.

[0048] That is, the co-formed product of efinaconazole has excellent stability, as shown in FIG. 5.

[0049] Furthermore, the co-formed product of efinaconazole can increase the solubility and dissolution rate of the drug, with the result that the uptake of the drug into the body is changed, resulting in a change in bioavailability.

[0050] That is, the co-formed product of efinaconazole has excellent bioavailability, as shown in FIG. 6.

[0051] Based on these features, the co-formed product of efinaconazole meets all requirements (that is, requirements in terms of chemical purity of the crystal, stability to a solution and temperature, and bioavailability when administered orally) for use as an active ingredient of the pharmaceutical composition.

[0052] The stability or bioavailability of the co-formed product of efinaconazole will be more fully understood with reference to the Examples section that follows.

[0053] The pharmaceutical composition of the present invention includes a prophylactically or therapeutically effective amount of the efinaconazole as an active ingredient. The amount of the active ingredient is determined based on safety and effectiveness data. In some embodiments, the therapeutically effective amount may be from about 0.01 to about 30 mg/kg. In some specific embodiments, the therapeutically effective amount may be from about 0.01 to about 6 mg/kg. Thus, the content of efinaconazole in a formulation for oral administration may be 0.6 to 2040 mg or 0.6 to 410 mg but is not necessarily limited thereto. The efinaconazole content may vary depending on clinical findings.

[0054] The pharmaceutically acceptable additive may be selected from, but not limited to, pharmaceutical additives that are obvious and widely known to those skilled in the art. Examples of such pharmaceutically acceptable additives include stabilizers, surfactants, lubricants, solubilizers, buffers, sweeteners, bases, adsorbents, bitterants, binders, suspending agents, curing agents, antioxidants, brighteners, flavors, flavoring agents, pigments, coating agents, wetting agents, wettability control agents, fillers, defoamers, refrigerants, masticatories, antistatic agents, colorants, sugar-coated agents, isotonic agents, softeners, emulsifiers, pressure-sensitive adhesives, thickeners, blowing agents, pH adjusting agents, excipients, dispersants, disintegrants, waterproofing agents, antiseptics, preservatives, dissolution aids, solvents, and fluidizers. More specifically, the pharmaceutically acceptable additive may be selected from the group consisting of excipients, binders, disintegrants, surfactants, lubricants, colorants, and mixtures thereof.

[0055] Examples of the excipients include lactose hydrate, microcrystalline cellulose, microcrystalline cellulose-lactose, methyl cellulose, ethyl cellulose, hydroxyethyl cellulose,

lose, hydroxypropyl cellulose, hydroxypropyl methyl cellulose, carboxymethyl cellulose salts, other substituted and unsubstituted celluloses, corn starch, pregelatinized starch, lactose, anhydrous lactose, sugar alcohols, sucrose, xylitol, acrylate polymers and copolymers, dextrans, dextrin, dextrose, maltodextrin, pectin, gelatin, and inorganic diluents.

[0056] Examples of the binders include polyvinyl alcohol-polyethylene glycol graft copolymers, polyvinylpyrrolidone vinyl acetate, ethyl cellulose, hydroxypropyl cellulose, hydroxypropyl methyl cellulose, carboxymethyl cellulose, methyl cellulose, polyvinyl alcohol, polyvinylpyrrolidone, polyacrylic acid, gelatin, propylene glycol, and sodium alginate.

[0057] Examples of the disintegrants include croscarmellose sodium, crospovidone, carboxymethyl cellulose salts, hydroxypropyl cellulose, microcrystalline cellulose, pregelatinized starch, sodium starch, glycolate, and sodium starch glycolate.

[0058] Examples of the surfactants include sodium dodecyl sulfonate (SDS), sodium lauryl sulfate (SLS), Pluronic F127, Pluronic F68, poly(ethylene glycol) (PEG), polyoxyethylene sorbitan monooleate (Tween 80), Poloxamer (Lutrol F68), polyethylene glycol-15-hydroxystearate (Solutol HS15), hydroxypropyl methyl cellulose (HPMC), poly(N-vinyl-2-pyrrolidone) (PVP), Silwet L77, poly(vinyl-alcohol) (PVA), bovine serum albumin (BSA), and sucrose fatty acid esters.

[0059] Examples of the lubricants include, but are not necessarily limited to, magnesium stearate, sodium stearyl fumarate, and glyceryl behenate. The lubricants may be, but not limited to, pharmaceutical additives that are obvious and widely known to those skilled in the art.

[0060] The composition of the present invention can be used to prevent or treat a fungal infection. Specific examples of indications for the fungal infection include, but are not limited to, candidal vaginitis, *Tinea versicolor*, *Tinea corporis* caused by dermatophytes, *Tinea capitis* (jock itch), *Tinea manus*, *tinea pedis*, oral candidiasis, fungal keratitis, onychomycosis, aspergillosis, candidiasis, candiduria, candidemia, cryptococcosis (including cryptococcal meningitis), paracoccidioidomycosis, systemic fungal infections, seborrheic dermatitis, and dandruff caused by yeast.

[0061] The present invention will be more specifically explained with reference to the following examples. How-

ever, it is to be noted that these examples are not intended to limit the scope of the invention.

EXAMPLES

Example 1—Preparation of Co-Crystal of Efinaconazole and Polyethylene Glycol (1:1 Ratio)

[0062] Efinaconazole (1 g) was dissolved in acetonitrile (5 mL) with stirring at room temperature. Polyethylene glycol-6000 (1 g) was added to the solution, followed by stirring for 1 h. The solvent was distilled off under reduced pressure. Spontaneous formation of a co-crystal of efinaconazole and polyethylene glycol-6000 was observed within a short time. After drying under vacuum, the crystal was recovered in a yield of 95%. The purity of the crystal was 99.5%. A powder X-ray diffraction (XRD) spectrum and a differential scanning calorimetry thermogram of the co-crystal of efinaconazole and polyethylene glycol-6000 are shown in FIGS. 1 and 2, respectively.

Example 2—Preparation of Oral Liquid Formulation

[0063] The co-crystal prepared in Example 1 and a solution of methylcellulose (0.5%) dispersed in distilled water containing surfactant (1%) were vortexed and sonicated to prepare a homogeneous oral liquid formulation. The components and their amounts are specifically shown in Table 1.

TABLE 1

Application category		Component	Amount allowed
1	Major ingredient	Example 1	69 mg
2	Excipient	Methyl cellulose	50 mg
3	Surfactant	Tween 80	100 µl
4	Solvent	Purified water	10 ml

Example 3—Preparation of Oral Tablets

[0064] The co-crystal prepared in Example 1 and excipients were kneaded, and disintegrants and lubricants were sequentially added thereto. The resulting particles were milled and compressed into uncoated tablets. The components and their amounts are specifically shown in Table 2.

Example 4—Preparation of Oral Capsules

TABLE 2

Application Category		Component	Amount allowed		Amount used	
			1T (mg)	600	T/g	Proportion (%)
1	Major ingredient	Example 1	7.50	4.50		7.50%
2	Excipient	Lactose hydrate	50.00	30.00		50.00%
3	Excipient	Microcrystalline cellulose	31.00	18.60		31.00%
5	Disintegrant	Low-substituted hydroxypropyl cellulose	5.00	3.00		5.00%
6	Disintegrant	Crospovidone	5.00	3.00		5.00%
7	Lubricant	Colloidal silica	0.50	0.30		0.50%
8	Lubricant	Magnesium stearate	1.00	0.60		1.00%

[0065] The milled particles before tableting in Example 3 were filled in gelatin capsules to prepare capsules.

Test Examples

[Stability Test]

[0066] The stability of the co-crystal of efinaconazole to temperature and a solution was evaluated and compared with that of efinaconazole by the following experimental method.

* Experimental Method

[0067] A co-crystalline form of efinaconazole was prepared. After each of the co-crystalline form and the co-crystal prepared in Example 1 was dissolved in a solution and allowed to stand at different temperatures (at room temperature and in an oven at 65° C.) for different periods of time (1 week, 2 weeks, and 4 weeks), its purities were determined by high-performance liquid chromatography (HPLC).

[0068] The results are shown in Table 3 and FIG. 5.

TABLE 3

Solution (10%)	Temp. (° C.)	After 1 week		After 2 weeks		After 4 weeks	
		HPLC (%)	Related substances (%)	HPLC (%)	Related substances (%)	HPLC (%)	Related substances (%)
Efinaconazole	Room	99.73	0.27	99.61	0.39	99.60	0.40
Example 1	temp.	99.79	0.21	99.80	0.20	99.79	0.21
Efinaconazole	65	99.55	0.45	99.46	0.54	98.47	1.53
Example 1		99.80	0.18	99.81	0.19	99.30	0.70

[0069] As can be seen from the results in Table 3 and FIG. 5, the co-crystal of efinaconazole was more stable at the temperatures and the solution than the crystalline form of efinaconazole, thus being more useful in the preparation of medicaments. In addition, the co-crystal of efinaconazole is considered as a novel substance that meets all requirements for use as an active ingredient of a pharmaceutical composition.

[Pre-Clinical Trials]

[0070] 24 male beagle dogs were divided into 4 groups, 6 animals per group. Voriconazole as a control drug was once administered to the animals via an oral route under fasting conditions. Efinaconazole as a test drug was once administered to the animals via intravenous and oral routes under fasting conditions. Thereafter, the pharmacokinetic (PK) profiles of the drugs were determined to calculate PK parameters of the drugs and evaluate the pharmacokinetics of the drugs. Specific test conditions and methods are as follows.

1. Preparation of Test Materials

[0071] For oral administration, the doses of voriconazole (oral administration group G1), efinaconazole (oral administration group G2), and the co-crystal of efinaconazole prepared in Example 1 (oral administration group G3—efinaconazole copolymer) were calculated based on the body weights of the animals. The test substances were weighed with an electronic balance. Each of the weighed test sub-

stances was placed in a glass container and 0.5% methylcellulose in a 1% Tween 80 solution (distilled water) as an excipient was added thereto. The mixture was vortexed and sonicated to prepare a homogeneous test material.

[0072] For intravenous administration, the doses of efinaconazole (intravenous administration group G1) were calculated based on the body weights of the animals. To the test substance was added PEG400 as an excipient whose volume corresponded to 30% of the total volume of a final test material. The mixture was vortexed and sonicated for complete dissolution. To the solution was added ethanol in an amount corresponding to 20% of the total volume of the test material, followed by homogenization by sonication. Then, 0.9% saline was added in an amount corresponding to 50% of the total volume of the test material, followed by vortexing and sonication to in situ prepare the test material in a homogeneous state.

2. Administration

[0073] Routes of administration: Intravenous (IV) and oral (PO)

[0074] Doses: G1 (Voriconazole)—6 mg/5 ml/kg (PO); G2 (Efinaconazole)—6 mg/5 ml/kg (PO); G3 (Efinaconazole-Polymer)—6 mg/5 ml/kg (PO); G1 (Efinaconazole)—0.5 mg/I ml/kg (IV)

[0075] Frequency of administration: Single dose (once daily)—(QD)

[0076] The compositions of the test materials administered are shown in Table 4.

TABLE 4

Group	Substance	Dose (mg/kg)	Dosage volume (ml/kg)	Route of administration	Frequency of administration	Number of animals (n)	Animal Nos.
Oral administration							
G1	Voriconazole	6	5	P.O	1	6	1-6
G2	Efinaconazole	6	5	P.O	1	6	7-12
G3	Efinaconazole co-crystal (copolymer)	6	5	P.O	1	6	13-18
Intravenous administration							
G1	Efinaconazole	0.5	1	I.V	1	6	1-6

3. Test Results

[0077] Animal Nos. 1-6, Nos. 7-12, and Nos. 13-18 were assigned to oral administration groups G1, G2, and G3, respectively, and animal Nos. 1-6 were assigned to intravenous administration group G1. On the test day, the average body weights of oral administration groups G1, G2, and G3 were measured to be 11.5 ± 1.2 kg, 11.5 ± 1.3 kg, and 11.5 ± 1.0 kg, respectively, and that of intravenous administration group G1 was measured to be 11.6 ± 1.6 kg.

[0078] During testing, no abnormal symptoms (including vomiting, limpness, diarrhea, and behavioral abnormalities) associated with the administration of the test materials were observed. There were no cases of death and blood collection proceeded smoothly over the entire test period. 4 ml of blood was collected from each point and centrifuged. 500 μ l of the plasma supernatant was dispensed in a 1.5 ml EP tube and the remaining plasma was dispensed into a set of 1.5 ml EP tubes. The samples were stored in a deep freezer at -80° C. After completion of the testing, the blood collection records, sample information certificates, dispensing records, clinical symptom observation records, medication/blood collection results, and test samples (plasma samples) were sent to a specialized analysis agency.

[0079] After storage in a freezer, the samples were analyzed by LC/MS/MS and their pharmacokinetic parameters were calculated in a noncompartmental manner using "Phoenix WinNonlin (Version 8.2 or higher, Certara L. P)" software.

[0080] For analysis of the plasma samples, animal Nos. 1-6 were assigned to voriconazole group G1 (6 mg/kg, P.O) and animal Nos. 1-6, Nos. 7-12, and Nos. 13-18 were assigned to efinaconazole groups G2 (0.6 mg/kg, I.V), G3 (6 mg/kg, P.O), and G4 (copolymer, 6 mg/kg, P.O), respectively, as shown in Table 5.

TABLE 5

No. of animal	Group	Body weight (kg)
G1-1	Voriconazole (6 mg/kg, P.O)	10.5
G1-2		12.4
G1-3		9.7
G1-4		11.8
G1-5		12.0
G1-6		12.8
Mean		11.5
SD		1.2
G1-1	Efinaconazole (0.5 mg/kg, I.V)	11.9
G1-2		12.8
G1-3		12.5
G1-4		13.0
G1-5		8.8
G1-6		10.4
Mean		11.6
SD		1.6
G2-7	Efinaconazole (6 mg/kg, P.O)	12.8
G2-8		13.0
G2-9		10.0
G2-10		11.9
G2-11		11.2
G2-12		10.3
Mean		11.5
SD		1.3
G3-13	Efinaconazole copolymer (6 mg/kg, P.O)	12.4
G3-14		10.1
G3-15		12.6
G3-16		10.6
G3-17		11.3
G3-18		12.2
Mean		11.5
SD		1.0

[0081] After the drugs were once administered to the 4 groups, 6 animals per group, a total of 24 test samples were analyzed. The trends of blood concentrations of voriconazole and efinaconazole are shown in FIGS. 6 and 7 and Tables 6 and 7. Peaks detected in some of the test samples were below the limit of quantification and were expressed as BLQ.

TABLE 6

		Unit: ng/mL											
	Animal	Time (hr)											
Group	ID	0	0.053	0.25	0.5	1	2	4	6	8	10	12	24
Voriconazole (6 mg/kg, P.O)	G1-1	ND	1132	3648.4	2876.1	3182.9	2948.8	2805.9	2521.4	2259.5	2120.2	2024.7	1379.8
	G1-2	ND	BLQ	2193.5	3460.4	3085.6	2608.7	2161.2	2019.7	1969.4	1873.1	1907.3	1516.4
	G1-3	ND	515.4	2997.1	3332.8	3929.7	3696.3	3858.9	3247	2944.7	2700.7	2538.3	1368
	G1-4	ND	BLQ	2598.5	3738.8	3684.9	3433.9	3385.8	2941.9	2880.4	2615.7	2590.8	1920.8
	G1-5	ND	1012.1	3523.2	3278.3	3282.3	3001.4	2937	2657.2	2427.6	2252.1	2163.4	1471.1

TABLE 6-continued

Unit: ng/mL													
	Animal	Time (hr)											
Group	ID	0	0.053	0.25	0.5	1	2	4	6	8	10	12	24
	G1-6	ND	BLQ	1365.3	3746.2	3453.5	2879.5	2549	2274.7	2255.4	2049.3	1840.7	1317.8
	Mean	0.00	443.25	2721.00	3405.43	3436.48	3094.77	2949.63	2610.32	2456.17	2268.52	2177.53	1495.65
	SD	0.00	527.75	861.51	326.16	321.39	397.36	603.32	444.27	383.51	326.80	319.68	220.51

TABLE 7

Unit: ng/mL													
Animal		Time (hr)											
Group	ID	0	0.053	0.25	0.5	1	2	4	6	8	10	12	24
Efinaconazole (0.5 mg/kg, I.V)	G1-1	ND	248.82	154.1	117.05	64.51	25.78	7.55	2.77	BLQ	BLQ	3.52	BLQ
	G1-2	ND	406.83	223.04	373.53	89.09	41.3	24.4	10.53	7.94	5.98	BLQ	BLQ
	G1-3	ND	327.75	203.77	129.45	76.78	31.91	12.93	5.3	3.73	2.71	2.19	BLQ
	G1-4	ND	342.72	216.79	122.56	53.54	22.23	11.56	4.91	3.55	2.51	2.46	BLQ
	G1-5	ND	261.82	168.19	85.65	42.41	17.58	7.59	3.48	2.56	2.23	BLQ	BLQ
	G1-6	ND	345.28	170.86	85.29	46.02	16.68	6.03	3.31	BLQ	BLQ	BLQ	BLQ
	Mean	0.00	322.20	189.46	118.46	61.06	25.91	11.68	5.05	2.96	2.24	1.36	0.00
	SD	0.00	58.61	28.73	28.73	17.45	9.39	0.77	2.86	2.95	2.23	1.56	0.00
Efinaconazole (6 mg/kg, P.O)	G2-7	ND	5.43	836.55	789.39	618.28	186.41	50.23	17.56	33.68	8.44	7.29	7.09
	G2-8	ND	3.69	39.83	596.77	766.14	185.9	54.08	20.45	34.48	9.86	8.97	5.77
	G2-9	ND	11.8	798.16	733.28	344.55	156.18	75.85	29.21	22.46	15.31	12.62	7.13
	G2-10	ND	34.76	1284.78	1381.96	636.01	289.5	122.03	57.99	33.62	28.2	20.26	13.13
	G2-11	ND	2.87	713.21	979.14	420.45	139.59	46.93	20.62	17.17	12.74	9.79	5.5
	G2-12	ND	19.03	788.67	612.63	291.84	101.83	40.41	19.37	12.24	10.04	7.84	2.87
	Mean	0.00	12.93	743.53	848.86	512.88	176.57	64.92	27.53	18.94	14.10	11.13	6.92
	SD	0.00	12.31	400.68	295.78	187.70	63.73	30.46	15.46	8.04	7.33	4.85	3.42
Efinaconazole copolymer (6 mg/kg, P.O)	G3-13	ND	7.34	1408.96	910.93	334.05	124.66	51.49	21.8	12.97	11.48	9.62	9.79
	G3-14	ND	5.12	666.25	437.50	182.45	73.99	32.78	14.75	10.81	9.13	7.59	4.35
	G3-15	ND	4.7	263.89	596.5	227.64	89.2	35.62	16.6	11.56	9.2	7.22	5.74
	G3-16	ND	16.24	625.88	458.49	276.66	100.54	37.84	10.93	9.59	6.48	6.18	3.63
	G3-17	ND	2.69	281.25	554.81	349.92	88.17	29.35	11.26	7.26	6.39	5.12	2.97
	G3-18	ND	73.78	1109.97	658.25	374.04	131.3	49.65	23.99	14.83	11.34	9.36	7.74
	Mean	0.00	18.31	726.03	602.76	290.79	101.32	39.46	16.22	11.02	9.00	7.52	5.70
	SD	0.00	27.59	455.83	172.33	75.13	22.41	9.09	4.89	2.54	2.23	1.26	2.62

[0082] AUC_t, a bioavailability parameter, is the area under the plasma concentration-time curve from the time of administration medication to the last time point of blood collection with a measurable concentration and was calculated by the trapezoidal formula. C_{max} is the highest plasma drug concentration read from the plasma drug concentration-time curve of each sample and T_{max} is the time taken to

reach the highest plasma drug concentration read from the plasma drug concentration-time curve of each sample. AUC_∞ is the area under the plasma concentration-time curve from the time of administration to time infinity. The calculated PK parameters of voriconazole and efinaconazole are shown in Table 8.

TABLE 8

Group	Animal ID	PK parameter					
		AUCt (ng · hr/mL)	C _{max} (ng/mL)	T _{max} (hr)	AUC _∞ (ng · hr/mL)	AUC _t / AUC _∞	t _{1/2} (hr)
Voriconazole (6 mg/kg, P.O)	G1-1	50656.804	3648.4	0.25	95293.252	53.159	22.42
	G1-2	46478.545	3460.4	0.5	137257.619	33.862	41.50
	G1-3	61909.545	3929.7	1	90370.291	68.507	14.42
	G1-4	63166.362	3738.8	0.5	143262.892	44.091	28.90
	G1-5	53572.487	3523.2	0.25	100841.396	53.125	22.27
	G1-6	47647.365	3746.2	0.5	88224.001	54.007	21.34
	Mean	53905.185	3674.45	0.500	109208.242	51.125	25.14
	SD	7138.888	169.60	0.274	24516.625	11.542	9.24
Efinaconazole (0.5 mg/kg, I.V)	G1-1	223.979	248.82	0.083	232.534	96.321	1.69
	G1-2	382.919	406.83	0.083	425.195	90.057	4.90
	G1-3	284.479	327.75	0.083	299.222	95.073	4.67
	G1-4	255.021	342.72	0.083	265.842	95.930	3.05
	G1-5	187.581	261.82	0.083	207.625	90.346	6.23

TABLE 8-continued

Group	Animal ID	PK parameter					
		AUCt (ng · hr/mL)	C _{max} (ng/mL)	T _{max} (hr)	AUC _∞ (ng · hr/mL)	AUC _t / AUC _∞	t _{1/2} (hr)
Efinaconazole (6 mg/kg, P.O)	G1-6	185.673	345.28	0.083	193.860	95.777	1.71
	Mean	253.275	322.20	0.083	270.713	93.917	3.71
	SD	74.200	58.61	0.000	84.906	2.908	1.85
	G2-7	1487.836	836.55	0.25	1519.873	97.892	3.13
	G2-8	1381.160	766.14	1	1534.017	90.036	18.36
	G2-9	1352.454	798.16	0.25	1490.139	90.760	13.35
	G2-10	2405.994	1381.96	0.5	2645.499	90.947	12.64
	G2-11	1337.413	979.14	0.5	1435.923	93.140	12.42
	G2-12	1004.398	788.67	0.25	1036.476	96.905	7.75
	Mean	1494.876	925.10	0.458	1610.321	93.280	11.27
Efinaconazole copolymer (6 mg/kg, P.O)	SD	475.135	236.42	0.292	540.325	3.369	5.22
	G3-13	1393.572	1408.96	0.25	1441.777	96.657	3.41
	G3-14	765.602	666.25	0.25	851.633	89.898	13.71
	G3-15	814.766	596.50	0.5	966.963	84.260	18.38
	G3-16	857.485	625.88	0.25	943.057	90.926	16.34
	G3-17	823.906	554.81	0.5	878.615	93.773	12.77
	G3-18	1272.555	1109.97	0.25	1604.902	79.292	29.76
	Mean	987.981	827.06	0.333	1114.491	89.134	15.73
	SD	271.622	349.93	0.129	323.575	6.364	8.59

[0083] As can be seen from the results in Table 8, the voriconazole group (6 mg/kg, P.O), efinaconazole group (0.6 mg/kg, IV), efinaconazole group (6 mg/kg, P.O), and efinaconazole copolymer group (6 mg/kg, P.O) were found to have the following PK parameters: AUCt values of 53,905.19±7,138.87, 253.28±74.20, 1,494.88±475.14, and 987.98±271.62, respectively; AUC_∞ values of 109,208.24±24,516.63, 270.71±84.91, 1,610.32±540.33, and 1,114.49±323.

58, respectively; and C_{max} values of 3,674.45±169.60, 322.20±58.61, 925.10±236.42, and 827.06±349.93, respectively.

[0084] Statistical analysis revealed that the parameters C_{max} and AUCt of the efinaconazole copolymer group (6 mg/kg, P.O) were significantly low compared to those of the efinaconazole group (6 mg/kg, P.O) (see Tables 9-12).

TABLE 9

Treatment	Parameter	Geometric mean ratio	Geometric Means		P-value
			Efinaconazole G2	Voriconazole	
Voriconazole G1-	C _{max}	0.2463	904.0399	3671.2005	<.0001*
Efinaconazole G2	AUC _t	0.0269	1441.7719	53521.3949	<.0001*

TABLE 10

Treatment	Parameter	Geometric mean ratio	Geometric Means		P-value
			Efinaconazole G3	Voriconazole	
Voriconazole G1-	C _{max}	0.2110	774.4894	3671.2005	<.0001*
Efinaconazole G3	AUC _t	0.0179	959.7515	53521.8049	<.0001*

TABLE 11

Treatment	Parameter	Geometric mean ratio	Geometric Means		P-value
			Efinaconazole G3	Voriconazole G2	
Efinaconazole G2-	C _{max}	0.8567	774.4894	904.0399	0.4143
Efinaconazole G3	AUC _t	0.6857	959.7515	1441.7759	0.0267*

TABLE 12

Treatment	Parameter	Geometric	Geometric Means		P-value
		mean ratio	Efinaconazole G3	Efinaconazole G1	
Efinaconazole G1-	C _{max}	2.4379	774.4894	317.6819	0.0004*
Efinaconazole G3	AUC _t	3.9160	959.7515	245.0823	<.0001*

[0085] The bioavailabilities of the efinaconazole copolymer group (6 mg/kg, P.O) and the efinaconazole group (6 mg/kg, P.O) were found to be 35.69±22.61% and 51.36±24.63%, respectively (see Tables 13 and 14).

TABLE 13

Bioavailability F(%)								
Parameter	Mean	SD	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦
⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦
⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦

⑦
⑦ indicates text missing or illegible when filed

TABLE 14

Bioavailability F(%)								
Parameter	Mean	SD	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦
⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦
⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦	⑦

⑦
⑦ indicates text missing or illegible when filed

[0086] The AUC_t level of the efinaconazole copolymer group (6 mg/kg, P.O) was found to be significantly low corresponding to 66% of that of the efinaconazole group (6 mg/kg, P.O) but is regarded as substantially exceeding that of the efinaconazole group considering that the content of the raw substance in the copolymer formulation was 50%.

[0087] The bioavailability of the efinaconazole copolymer group (6 mg/kg, P.O) was 35.69%, which corresponds to ~70% of that of the efinaconazole group (6 mg/kg, P.O) (51.36%) under the premise that dose linearity is given, revealing that the degree of exposure of the efinaconazole copolymer (test substance) formulation in the body of the beagle dogs is much higher than the theoretically expected level (50%).

[0088] These test results concluded that the bioavailability of efinaconazole is higher than those of other antifungals, including voriconazole and itraconazole, when administered orally even at a low dose. Therefore, oral administration of efinaconazole is expected to be therapeutically very effective.

1. A pharmaceutical composition for oral use comprising a co-formed product of efinaconazole and polyethylene glycol and a pharmaceutically acceptable additive.

2. The pharmaceutical composition according to claim 1, wherein the pharmaceutical composition is formulated into a tablet or solution.
3. The pharmaceutical composition according to claim 1, wherein the pharmaceutical composition comprises 0.6 to 2040 mg of the efinaconazole.
4. The pharmaceutical composition according to claim 1, wherein the weight ratio of the efinaconazole to the polyethylene glycol in the co-formed product is 1:1.
5. The pharmaceutical composition according to claim 1, wherein the pharmaceutically acceptable additive is selected from the group consisting of excipients, binders, disintegrants, surfactants, lubricants, colorants, and mixtures thereof.
6. The pharmaceutical composition according to claim 5, wherein the excipients are lactose hydrate, microcrystalline cellulose, microcrystalline cellulose-lactose, methyl cellulose, ethyl cellulose, hydroxyethyl cellulose, hydroxypropyl cellulose, hydroxypropyl methyl cellulose, carboxymethyl cellulose salts, other substituted and unsubstituted celluloses, corn starch, pregelatinized starch, lactose, anhydrous lactose, sugar alcohols, sucrose, xylitol, acrylate polymers and copolymers, dextrates, dextrin, dextrose, maltodextrin, pectin, gelatin, inorganic diluents, and mixtures thereof.
7. The pharmaceutical composition according to claim 5, wherein the binders are polyvinyl alcohol-polyethylene glycol graft copolymers, polyvinylpyrrolidone vinyl acetate, ethyl cellulose, hydroxypropyl cellulose, hydroxypropyl methyl cellulose, carboxymethyl cellulose, methyl cellulose, polyvinyl alcohol, polyvinylpyrrolidone, polyacrylic acid, gelatin, propylene glycol, sodium alginate, and mixtures thereof.
8. The pharmaceutical composition according to claim 5, wherein the disintegrants are croscarmellose sodium, crospovidone, carboxymethyl cellulose salts, hydroxypropyl cellulose, microcrystalline cellulose, pregelatinized starch, sodium starch, glycolate, sodium starch glycolate, and mixtures thereof.
9. The pharmaceutical composition according to claim 5, wherein the lubricants are magnesium stearate, sodium stearyl fumarate, glyceryl behenate, and mixtures thereof.
10. The pharmaceutical composition according to claim 1, wherein the pharmaceutical composition is used to prevent or treat a fungal infection.
11. The pharmaceutical composition according to claim 10, wherein the fungal infection is onychomycosis.

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